

JanGyan — Learn Without Limits

Category 2: Government Services & Citizen Rights

Module 3 - Digital Government Services

Module Overview

This handbook is your complete, beginner-to-advanced guide to **Digital Government Services** — covering DigiLocker, UMANG, MyGov, e-Sign, Aadhaar Services, PAN Services, Passport Seva, and the broader world of national digital platforms and online government portals. India has built one of the world's largest digital public service ecosystems; this module shows you exactly how to use it, safely and confidently.

By the end of this module, you will not need to search anywhere else to understand how India's digital government services work and how to make the most of them.

Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- Explain the purpose of DigiLocker, UMANG, MyGov, and e-Sign
- Use Aadhaar-based digital services for identity verification and document signing
- Navigate PAN Services and Passport Seva through official digital channels
- Understand what "National Digital Platforms" means and why India built them
- Identify genuine government portals and avoid fraudulent look-alikes
- Apply digital service best practices to protect your data and identity

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Why This Topic Matters

UMANG, India's unified government services app, now hosts **1,745 services** from around 80 central departments and 30 states, used by **5.58 crore citizens** and processing over **383 crore cumulative transactions**. **MyGov**, the government's citizen engagement platform, has crossed **6 crore registered users**. **DigiLocker** has issued more than **9.81 billion digital documents** to over 550 million users.

> *Reality Check: Many citizens still visit physical government offices for services that can now be completed entirely online in minutes — often because they are unaware these digital platforms exist or don't trust them due to confusion with fraudulent look-alike websites.*

Digital government services save time, reduce corruption risk, and make services accessible from anywhere — but only for citizens who know how to find and use the genuine platforms confidently.

Introduction

India's digital government ecosystem is often described as part of the **"India Stack"** — a set of shared digital public infrastructure layers (identity, payments, data) that multiple applications build on top of. This module focuses on the citizen-facing platforms built on that foundation:

- **DigiLocker** — your digital document wallet
- **UMANG** — a single app aggregating thousands of government services
- **MyGov** — the citizen engagement and participation platform
- **e-Sign** — Aadhaar-based electronic document signing
- **Aadhaar Services, PAN Services, Passport Seva** — core identity and document services now available digitally
- **National Digital Platforms & Online Portals** — the wider ecosystem, and how to use it safely

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Fundamental Concepts

Types of Digital Government Platforms

Type	Purpose	Examples
Service Aggregator	Bundles many government services into one app	UMANG
Document Platform	Stores and verifies digital documents	DigiLocker
Engagement Platform	Enables citizen participation in governance	MyGov
Authentication/Signature Service	Verifies identity or signs documents digitally	e-Sign, Aadhaar authentication
Departmental Portal	A single department's own dedicated online service	Passport Seva, Income Tax e-Filing

G2C: Government-to-Citizen Services

Most platforms in this module fall under **G2C (Government-to-Citizen)** services — digital services delivered directly by government bodies to individual citizens, as distinct from G2B (Government-to-Business) or G2G (Government-to-Government) services.

Complete Detailed Explanation

Part A — DigiLocker

Definition: A secure, MeitY-backed digital document wallet giving every citizen access to government-issued documents in digital form.

How it works: Sign up using your Aadhaar number and mobile OTP; link documents such as Driving Licence, mark sheets, or vehicle registration directly from issuing departments; digital copies are accepted at par with physical originals for most official purposes.

Indian context: Over 550 million registered users and more than 9.81 billion documents issued as of 2025.

Part B — UMANG (Unified Mobile Application for New-age Governance)

Definition: A "mobile-first" super-app, developed by MeitY and the National e-Governance Division (NeGD), providing single-point access to services from central ministries, state departments, and local bodies.

Why it matters: Before UMANG, citizens had to install a separate app for nearly every department; UMANG consolidates this into one platform, available via app, web, SMS, and IVR (phone call) channels.

How it works: Log in using your Aadhaar-linked mobile number and OTP; browse services by category (e.g., EPFO, DigiLocker, PAN, Passport, gas booking) and complete transactions directly within the app.

Indian context: Launched on 23 November 2017; as of recent data, it hosts 1,745 services from roughly 80 central departments/ministries/autonomous bodies and 30 states, with a user base of 5.58 crore and 383 crore cumulative transactions.

Part C — MyGov

Definition: India's official citizen engagement platform, launched on 26 July 2014, enabling citizens to contribute ideas, suggestions, and feedback directly to government policy-making.

Why it matters: It gives ordinary citizens a direct channel to participate in governance — through discussions, polls, quizzes, blogs, pledges, and creative contests — rather than being purely passive recipients of services.

Indian context: MyGov has crossed **6 crore (60 million) registered users** and operates in 12 languages, with state-level instances in over 20 States/UTs.

Part D — e-Sign (Aadhaar-Based Electronic Signature)

Definition: An online service allowing any Aadhaar holder to digitally sign a document using Aadhaar-based authentication (OTP or biometric), carrying the same legal weight as a handwritten signature.

Why it matters: It eliminates the need for printing, physically signing, and scanning documents — while remaining fully legally binding.

Legal basis: Recognised under **Section 3A of the Information Technology Act, 2000**, and the **Electronic Signature or Electronic Authentication Technique and Procedure Rules, 2015**, regulated by the Controller of Certifying Authorities (CCA) under MeitY. e-Signed documents are admissible as evidence in court.

Limitations: Certain documents — including wills, negotiable instruments (other than cheques), and powers of attorney for immovable property — cannot be executed using e-Sign and still require traditional signatures.

Part E — Aadhaar Services

Beyond basic identity proof, Aadhaar underpins a wide range of digital services: **e-KYC** for opening bank accounts, **Aadhaar authentication** for direct benefit transfers, **masked Aadhaar** and **Virtual ID (VID)** for privacy, and **biometric lock/unlock** for added security. Most other platforms in this module — DigiLocker, UMANG, e-Sign — rely on Aadhaar authentication as their identity backbone.

Part F — PAN Services

PAN-related services — new applications, corrections, and reprints — are being consolidated under the **PAN 2.0 Project** into a single unified portal, replacing the earlier arrangement of three separate platforms (e-Filing portal, NSDL/Protean, and UTIITSL). New and reprinted cards carry an encrypted, dynamic **QR code** for instant verification.

Part G — Passport Seva

Definition: The Ministry of External Affairs' digital platform for passport applications, appointment booking, and status tracking.

How it works: Register on the Passport Seva portal, fill the application form online, book an appointment at a Passport Seva Kendra, and track status digitally; the **Tatkal** scheme offers expedited processing for urgent needs.

Part H — National Digital Platforms (India Stack & Digital India)

Digital India, launched on 1 July 2015, is the umbrella programme under which most of these platforms were built, organised around pillars including broadband connectivity, universal mobile access, e-governance, and electronics manufacturing. The **India Stack** concept refers to shared digital infrastructure — identity (Aadhaar), payments (UPI), and data-sharing frameworks — that other government and private applications are built upon, avoiding the need for every service to build its own identity or payment system from scratch.

Part I — Online Government Portals: Recognising the Genuine Ones

Nearly every official Indian government portal uses a `.gov.in` or `.nic.in` domain. Fraudulent look-alike websites — mimicking passport, PAN, or ration card portals — often charge unnecessary "service fees" or harvest personal data. Always verify the exact domain before entering personal information, especially when arriving via a search engine ad or an unsolicited link.

Part J — Digital Service Best Practices

- Always start from an official portal or app, not a link shared via SMS/WhatsApp
- Use strong, unique passwords and enable 2FA wherever offered on these platforms
- Never share the OTP used for Aadhaar authentication, e-Sign, or e-KYC with anyone
- Keep your Aadhaar-linked mobile number updated, since most of these services depend on it

Important Terminologies

Term	Simple Meaning
G2C	Government-to-Citizen digital services
India Stack	Shared digital public infrastructure (identity, payments, data) underlying many services
NeGD	National e-Governance Division, which builds platforms like UMANG
e-KYC	Electronic identity verification, typically via Aadhaar
CCA	Controller of Certifying Authorities, regulating e-Sign in India
VID	Virtual ID, a temporary alternative to sharing your Aadhaar number
IVR	Interactive Voice Response, enabling phone-based access to services like UMANG

Step-by-Step Understanding

How to Use UMANG for a Government Service

1. Download the UMANG app or visit the UMANG web portal
2. Register/log in using your Aadhaar-linked mobile number and OTP
3. Search for the department or service you need (e.g., EPFO, Passport, DigiLocker)
4. Complete the service request directly within the app
5. Track status and receive notifications within UMANG itself

How to e-Sign a Document Using Aadhaar

1. Upload the document to an authorised e-Sign platform or service
2. Enter your Aadhaar number or Virtual ID (VID)
3. Receive and enter the OTP sent to your Aadhaar-linked mobile number
4. The system issues a one-time digital signature certificate and applies your signature
5. Download the signed, legally valid document

Real-Life Indian Examples

(Widely reported public initiatives, described for educational awareness.)

- **UMANG for EPFO Services:** Millions of salaried employees use UMANG to check their Provident Fund balance and passbook instead of visiting an EPFO office — one of the most heavily used services on the platform.
- **MyGov and Mann Ki Baat:** Citizens have long used MyGov to submit ideas and feedback directly considered for the Prime Minister's monthly radio address, illustrating direct citizen-to-government engagement.

- **e-Sign in Banking and Insurance:** Banks and insurers increasingly use Aadhaar-based e-Sign for loan agreements and policy documents, reducing paperwork while remaining fully legally binding.

Practical Scenarios

Scenario 1: You need to check your Provident Fund balance without visiting an EPFO office.
Use the UMANG app, which offers direct EPFO balance and passbook access.

Scenario 2: You want to give feedback on a new government policy under consideration.
Visit MyGov, where citizens can contribute ideas and participate in official discussions and polls.

Scenario 3: You need to sign a loan agreement quickly without printing and scanning documents.
Ask if the provider supports Aadhaar-based e-Sign — it's legally valid and can be completed in minutes.

Scenario 4: You receive a WhatsApp message with a link claiming to be for "PAN card verification."
Don't click it. Go directly to the official Income Tax e-filing portal or use UMANG's PAN service instead.

Government Rules / Guidelines

- **MeitY & NeGD:** Develop and maintain UMANG, DigiLocker, and MyGov as part of the Digital India programme.
- **Controller of Certifying Authorities (CCA):** Regulates e-Sign service providers and Certifying Authorities under the IT Act.
- **UIDAI:** Governs the Aadhaar authentication infrastructure underlying most of these platforms.

Laws & Policies

Law / Provision	What It Covers
IT Act, 2000 — Section 3A	Legal recognition of electronic signatures, including Aadhaar-based e-Sign
IT Act, 2000 — Section 5	Grants electronic signatures the same legal validity as handwritten signatures
Electronic Signature or Electronic Authentication Technique and Procedure Rules, 2015	Establishes the regulatory framework for e-Sign in India
Aadhaar Act, 2016	Governs Aadhaar authentication used across these digital platforms
Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023	Applies to personal data processed through these platforms, requiring reasonable security safeguards

Important Statistics

Metric	Figure
UMANG services available	1,745, from ~80 central bodies and 30 states
UMANG user base	5.58 crore
UMANG cumulative transactions	383 crore
MyGov registered users	Over 6 crore (60 million+)
MyGov supported languages	12
DigiLocker registered users	Over 550 million
Documents issued via DigiLocker	Over 9.81 billion
Digital India launch date	1 July 2015
e-Sign legal basis notified	28 January 2015 (Gazette Notification GSR 61(E))

(Figures are approximate, drawn from Digital India, MyGov, DigiLocker, and MeitY publications through 2025–2026.)

Best Practices

- Always access these services via official apps or `.gov.in`/`.nic.in` websites
- Keep your Aadhaar-linked mobile number current, since OTPs power most of these services
- Use masked Aadhaar or VID where full Aadhaar sharing isn't required
- Bookmark official portals instead of searching for them each time
- Verify any "processing fee" request independently — genuine government e-services rarely charge unofficial fees

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Common Mistakes

- Clicking unofficial links claiming to offer PAN, Aadhaar, or passport services
- Assuming physical office visits are always required when a digital option exists
- Sharing Aadhaar OTPs meant for e-Sign or e-KYC with a third party "to help"
- Using outdated or unofficial versions of government apps instead of the verified originals
- Not updating the Aadhaar-linked mobile number, causing OTP failures across multiple platforms

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Myths vs Facts

Myth	Fact
"e-Signed documents aren't as valid as handwritten signatures"	Aadhaar e-Sign carries the same legal validity as a handwritten signature under the IT Act
"UMANG only covers a few basic services"	UMANG hosts over 1,700 services across dozens of central and state bodies
"MyGov is just a government announcement page"	MyGov is an interactive platform where citizens actively contribute ideas considered in policymaking
"DigiLocker documents aren't accepted everywhere"	DigiLocker documents are accepted at par with physical originals by most official bodies
"All government portals with official-sounding names are genuine"	Many fraudulent look-alike sites mimic government portals; only `.gov.in`/`.nic.in` domains are official

Do's and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Use official apps/portals for government services	Don't rely on links shared via SMS/WhatsApp for such services
Keep your Aadhaar-linked mobile number updated	Don't ignore OTP failures — update your number promptly
Use e-Sign for eligible documents to save time	Don't attempt e-Sign for excluded documents like wills or property POA
Verify domains before entering personal data	Don't trust a portal purely because it looks official
Explore UMANG/MyGov/DigiLocker for services you assume need office visits	Don't assume every service still requires physical paperwork

Safety Tips

For Using Digital Platforms

- Download apps only from official app stores, verified against the developer name (MeitY/NeGD/relevant ministry)
- Never share OTPs sent for Aadhar authentication, e-Sign, or e-KYC with anyone
- Log out of shared or public devices after using any of these services

For Verifying Authenticity

- Check for `.gov.in`/`.nic.in` in the website address before entering any data
- Be suspicious of any request for payment through unofficial channels for these free/nominal-fee services

For Families & Seniors

- Help older family members set up DigiLocker and UMANG for convenience
- Explain that OTPs for these services should never be shared, exactly like banking OTPs

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Practical Checklist

- ☐ Set up DigiLocker and linked key documents
- ☐ Installed UMANG and explored relevant services (EPFO, PAN, etc.)
- ☐ Registered on MyGov if interested in citizen engagement
- ☐ Know how Aadhaar-based e-Sign works and its legal validity
- ☐ Verified official domains for Aadhaar, PAN, and Passport services
- ☐ Kept Aadhaar-linked mobile number updated

Quick Revision Notes

- DigiLocker = digital document wallet; UMANG = service aggregator app; MyGov = citizen engagement platform
- e-Sign = Aadhaar OTP/biometric-based electronic signature, legally equal to handwritten signatures
- Most platforms depend on Aadhaar authentication as their identity backbone
- Genuine government portals always use `.gov.in`/`.nic.in` domains
- Digital India (launched 2015) is the umbrella programme; India Stack is the shared infrastructure concept
- Never share OTPs used for these services with anyone

Key Takeaways

1. Most services citizens assume require an office visit are now available digitally
2. Aadhaar authentication is the common backbone linking DigiLocker, UMANG, and e-Sign
3. e-Sign is fully legally valid — not a lesser substitute for handwritten signatures
4. Verifying official domains protects you from fraudulent look-alike portals
5. A handful of these platforms, used well, can replace dozens of physical office visits

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Glossary

- **CCA** — Controller of Certifying Authorities, regulating e-Sign

- **DigiLocker** — India's government digital document wallet
- **e-Sign** — Aadhaar-based electronic signature service
- **G2C** — Government-to-Citizen digital services
- **India Stack** — Shared digital public infrastructure (identity, payments, data)
- **MyGov** — India's citizen engagement platform
- **NeGD** — National e-Governance Division
- **UMANG** — Unified Mobile Application for New-age Governance
- **VID** — Virtual ID, a temporary Aadhaar alternative

Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is UMANG?
A unified mobile app giving citizens access to thousands of government services from central and state bodies in one place.

2. What is MyGov?
India's citizen engagement platform, letting citizens contribute ideas and feedback directly to government policymaking.

3. What is DigiLocker?
A government digital document wallet storing verified digital copies of documents like Driving Licences and mark sheets.

4. What is e-Sign?
An Aadhaar-based electronic signature service, legally equivalent to a handwritten signature.

5. Is e-Sign legally valid in India?
Yes, under Section 3A of the IT Act, 2000, and the Electronic Signature Rules, 2015.

6. Can all documents be e-Signed?
No — wills, negotiable instruments (other than cheques), and property powers of attorney require traditional signatures.

7. When was UMANG launched?
On 23 November 2017, by MeitY and the National e-Governance Division.

8. When was MyGov launched?
On 26 July 2014.

9. How many users does MyGov have?
Over 6 crore (60 million+) registered users.

10. How many services does UMANG offer?
Around 1,745 services from roughly 80 central bodies and 30 states.

11. Are DigiLocker documents legally valid?
Yes, they are accepted at par with physical originals for most official purposes.

12. What is India Stack?
Shared digital public infrastructure — identity (Aadhaar), payments (UPI), and data-sharing frameworks — that other services build upon.

13. When was Digital India launched?
On 1 July 2015.

14. How do I verify a government website is genuine?
Check that it uses an official `.gov.in` or `.nic.in` domain.

15. Can I use UMANG without the internet?
Yes, some services are accessible via SMS or IVR (phone call) channels, not just the app.

16. What is a Virtual ID (VID)?
A temporary, revocable alternative to sharing your actual Aadhaar number.

17. Who regulates e-Sign providers in India?
The Controller of Certifying Authorities (CCA), under MeitY.

18. Can e-Signed documents be used as evidence in court?
Yes, they are admissible as electronic evidence under the applicable evidence law.

19. Is it safe to share an OTP for e-Sign or e-KYC with a customer service agent?
No — these OTPs should never be shared with anyone, including someone claiming to assist you.

20. What should I do if I receive a suspicious PAN/Aadhaar "verification" link?
Don't click it — go directly to the official portal or app instead.

21. Can DigiLocker be used without an Aadhaar number?
Aadhaar-based mobile OTP verification is the standard sign-up method for most users.

22. Where can I find the official UMANG, MyGov, and DigiLocker apps?
On official app stores, published by MeitY/NeGD, or via their official `.gov.in` websites.

Suggested Infographics, Flowcharts & Illustrations

(For JanGyan design team — placement suggestions only; no images generated here)

- **"India Stack" layered diagram (identity, payments, data)** → within "Introduction"
- **UMANG service categories icon grid** → within "Complete Detailed Explanation, Part B"
- **e-Sign step-by-step flow visual** → within "Step-by-Step Understanding"
- **Genuine vs fake government portal comparison card** → within "Complete Detailed Explanation, Part I"
- **Platform comparison table graphic (DigiLocker/UMANG/MyGov/e-Sign)** → within "Fundamental Concepts"

Official References

- Digital India (MeitY) — UMANG and MyGov official statistics and documentation
- DigiLocker (MeitY/NeGD) — official platform statistics
- Controller of Certifying Authorities (CCA) — e-Sign regulatory framework
- Information Technology Act, 2000, and the Electronic Signature Rules, 2015
- Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) — Aadhaar authentication documentation
- Ministry of External Affairs — Passport Seva citizen guidelines

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Official Government Website Links

- UMANG: **https://web.umang.gov.in**
- MyGov: **https://www.mygov.in**
- DigiLocker: **https://www.digilocker.gov.in**
- Digital India: **https://www.digitalindia.gov.in**
- UIDAI (Aadhaar): **https://uidai.gov.in**
- Income Tax e-Filing (PAN): **https://www.incometax.gov.in**
- Passport Seva: **https://www.passportindia.gov.in**

Conclusion

India has built one of the largest digital government service ecosystems in the world — DigiLocker, UMANG, MyGov, and Aadhaar-based e-Sign together bring dozens of once-physical processes onto your phone. The real barrier left isn't the technology; it's awareness. Knowing these platforms exist, trusting the genuine ones, and avoiding fraudulent look-alikes is what turns this infrastructure into real convenience for you.

This is the next step in your Government Services & Citizen Rights journey with JanGyan. Stay informed, stay digital, and remember: **the right app, used the right way, can replace an entire day of office visits.**

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Module 3 of the Government Services & Citizen Rights Category